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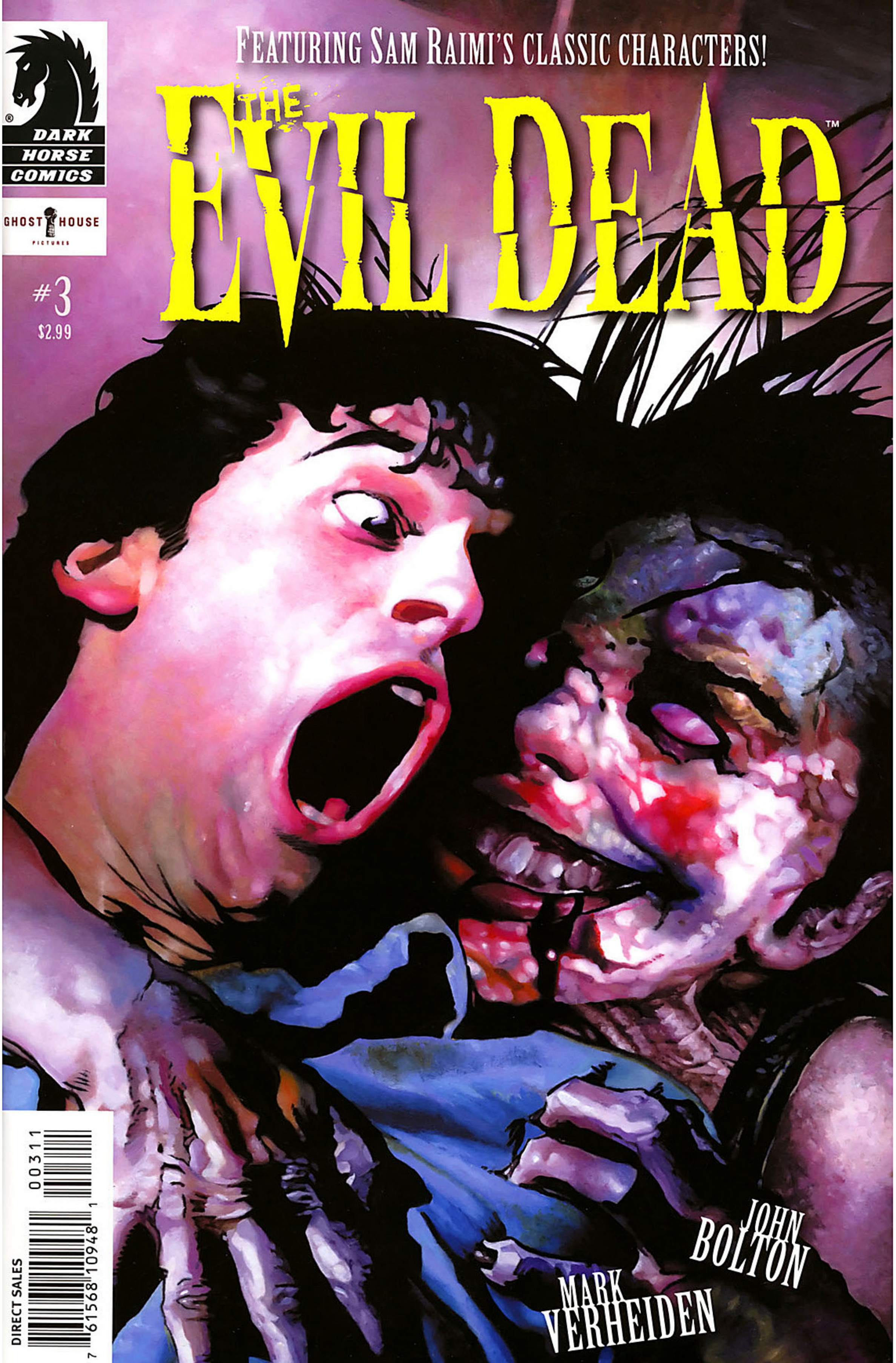
THE EVIL DEAD™



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THE EVIL DEAD

Book 3 of 4

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"SO SCOTTY WANTED TO *BURY* WHAT WAS LEFT OF SHELLY.

"*BURY* HER. *JESUS.*

"BUT IT WAS AS GOOD A PLAN AS *ANY,* GIVEN THAT *'PLAN A'* WAS HACKING HER TO BITS WITH AN *AX.*

"WE'D COME UP TO THE CABIN FOR A CHANCE AT *ROMANCE...*

"...BUT INSTEAD OF ROLLING *ON* THE SHEETS, WE WERE PILING DISMEMBERED BODY PARTS *IN* THEM.

"FUNNY HOW THE OL' LOVE MOTOR TENDS TO *STALL* WHEN YOUR SWEETIE TURNS INTO A *KANDARIAN DEMON.*

"SCOTTY MADE A MAKESHIFT *CROSS* OUT OF SOME BRANCHES AND STABBED IT INTO SHELLY'S GRAVE.

"NEVER FIGURED HIM FOR THE *RELIGIOUS* TYPE. GUESS HE WAS HEDGING HIS BETS.

"MY OLD MAN USED TO SAY, 'THERE'S NO SUCH THING AS AN *ATHEIST* IN A FOXHOLE.'

"WONDER IF HE'D HAVE ANY EQUALLY *USELESS* SAYINGS TO COVER A NIGHT LIKE THIS..."

"...BECAUSE SCOTTY'S NEW-FOUND *PIETY* WASN'T GOING TO GET US ANYWHERE.

DEAR GOD...WHAT HAVE WE *DONE,* SCOTTY?

"IF WE WERE GOING TO SURVIVE THIS, IT WOULD BE BY WORKING *TOGETHER.*

"UNFORTUNATELY, SCOTTY WASN'T EXACTLY *WITH THE PROGRAM.*"

THAT'S IT. I'M GETTING *OUT* OF HERE.

THERE'S GOTTA BE ANOTHER WAY TO THE *MAIN ROAD.* A *TRAIL* OR...

WHAT ARE YOU, *CRAZY?*

WE CAN'T TAKE LINDA ANYWHERE WITH HER LEG MESSED UP LIKE THAT--

LOOK! I'M GETTING *OUT!* I DON'T CARE WHAT HAPPENS TO HER!

SHE'S *YOUR* GIRLFRIEND. *YOU* TAKE CARE OF HER.

"SCOTTY ALWAYS 'LOOKED OUT FOR NUMERO UNO'...!

"I REMEMBER THINKING, OKAY, HE'S *SCARED.* HE JUST CHOPPED HIS GIRLFRIEND INTO *SPAGHETTI.*

"RUNNING WAS A DIPSHIT MOVE, BUT I COULDN'T GET *TOO* PISSED.

"BESIDES, HE WASN'T THE *ONLY* PANTS-PISSIN' 'BOYFRIEND' WHO WANTED TO RUN *SCREAMING* INTO THE NIGHT.

"I'M NOT TOO PROUD TO ADMIT I'D CONSIDERED BOLTING MYSELF."

LINDA...

"WAS I STAYING BECAUSE SHE *NEEDED* ME...

"...OR BECAUSE PLAYING *BODYGUARD* WAS EASIER THAN FACING WHATEVER LURKED OUTSIDE?

"YOU GROW UP ON A DIET OF *JOHN WAYNE* AND YOU'RE INSTILLED WITH CERTAIN IDEAS ABOUT *COURAGE.*"

AHGG! HEE HEE HEE HEE...

YAHHH!!

"BUT THE FRIGGIN' DUKE DID *HIS* FIGHTING ON HOLLYWOOD SETS.

"THIS LIVING NIGHTMARE WAS LAUGHING RIGHT IN MY FACE!"

"AND WORST OF ALL, WITH SCOTTY GONE, I WAS *ALL ALONE.*"

THERE'S GOTTA BE A WAY OUT OF THIS PIT.

LOGGING ROAD, HIKER'S PATH, *SOME-THING...*

WHOA. I DON'T *BELIEVE* THIS!

HEY, PAL! WAIT UP!

ME AND MY FRIENDS, WE...WE RAN INTO SOME... UHH...*TROUBLE* BACK IN THE WOODS.

THE BRIDGE IS OUT. SOME PEOPLE WERE *HURT!*

LOOK, I'LL TOSS IN A *TWENTY* AND SOME *BREW* IF YOU CAN WALK ME DOWN TO THE *MAIN ROAD.*

MY FRIENDS CALL ME *SCOTTY--*

FUNNY. SO DO *MINE.*

AHHH! WHO...WHO *ARE* YOU?

I'M *YOU,* PRETTY BOY.

KRAKK

GYAAAAHH!

I'M WHAT YOU'RE GOING TO *BE* IN ABOUT *FIVE MINUTES.*

WHAT DO YOU *THINK,* WILL THE GIRLS STILL LOVE US WITH *HALF OUR FACE GONE?*

OH, GOD! NOOOOOOO!

"JUST WHEN I WAS STARTING TO THINK SCOTTY PULLED AN *EINSTEIN* WITH HIS *CUT AND RUN* ROUTINE..."

AHHH!!

ASH...

HELP ME...

UHH... GOD... UHHGG...

SCOTTY, YOU'RE...YOU'RE GOING TO BE OKAY.

YEAH. YOU'LL BE *FINE.* YOU'LL SEE.

"NOW *LINDA* HAD GONE POSTAL, TOO."

HEE HEE HEE! HAAA...

YOU'LL SEE...HEE HEE HEE...

OH, GOD!

HEE HEE HEE HEE!

JUST... SHUT UP!

I SAID SHUT UP! SHUT UP! SHUT UP!

KRAKK

"OKAY. SO I WAS *LOSING* IT...

"...AND SCOTT WASN'T EXACTLY *HELPING.*"

K-KILL HER! *KILL HER!!*

"I REMEMBER LAUGHING WHEN HE TOSSED A RIFLE INTO THE TRUNK.

"HE SAID IT WAS FOR *PROTECTION,* FOR WHATEVER WE MIGHT RUN INTO."

GOD FORGIVE ME.

"GOOD OL' SCOTTY. EVEN A *BROKEN CLOCK* IS RIGHT TWICE A DAY."

ASH...

HELP ME, *PLEASE*...

"I HELD HER CLOSE, AND FOR AN INSTANT THE WORLD ROTATED *BACK* ON ITS AXIS."

PLEASE DON'T LET THEM TAKE ME AWAY AGAIN!

"SHE WAS *LINDA* AGAIN... MY SWEET LINDA...

"...AND THEN *CHERYL* CHIIMED IN."

ASH... ASH...LET ME OUT...

I...I'M *ALL RIGHT* NOW...

"SHE SOUNDED... ALMOST *NORMAL*."

CHERYL?

"YEAH. *SURE.* MAYBE IT WAS *OVER*..."

HERE, SIT DOWN...

ASH...IT'S NOT GOING TO LET US LEAVE...

CHERYL WAS *RIGHT*... WE'RE ALL GOING TO *DIE* HERE...

WE'RE NOT GONNA DIE! WE'RE GETTING *OUT* OF THIS!

LISTEN! SCOTTY! IS THERE A WAY *AROUND* THE BRIDGE?

SCOTTY! FOR GOD'S SAKE!!

WHAP

HNGHH... I DON'T WANNA *DIE*...DON'T LEAVE ME HERE, ASH...

I DON'T WANNA DIE! I DON'T WANNA DIE!

YOU'RE NOT GOING TO *LEAVE ME* HERE ARE YOU, ASH? ARE YOU?

HEE HEE HEE!

GYAGHH!

I'M *ALL RIGHT*, ASH!

UNLOCK THE CHAINS AND LET ME *OUT!* HA HA HAAAA!

HEE HEE HEE HEEEE!

WE'RE GONNA GET YOU! WE'RE GONNA GET YOU!

NOT ANOTHER PEEE-EEP, YOU'RE GONNA GO TO SLEEE-EEP!

"THE *HELLSPAWN* WERE JUST GETTIN' *WARMED UP.*"

YEEEEEEGHH!!

"THAT DID IT. IT WAS TIME TO TAKE OUT THE *TRASH.*"

IT'S USELESS... *USELESS...*

GHYGGGGG...

"WE'D TALKED ABOUT A FUTURE TOGETHER, MADE *SWEET LOVE* IN THE BACK OF MY ROADHOG, AND I DUMPED HER IN THE LEAVES LIKE SHE WAS *ROADKILL.*"

THEY'LL *COME* FOR YOU...

HHHHH.... HHHH... HHH...

"*NEW PLAN.* GRAB SCOTTY AND GET THE HELL OUTTA *DODGE.*"

OH GOD. *SCOTT...*

THE SUN'LL BE UP IN AN HOUR OR SO, AND WE CAN ALL GET OUT OF HERE... YOU, ME, LINDA, SHEL...

NO...NOT *SHELLY*...SHE'S... NEVERMIND...BUT WE'LL BE GOING *HOME.*

"SCOTTY...THEY'D PUT HIM DOWN FOR THE *DIRT NAP.*"

HEH HEH HEEEEH!

EEEEYARGHHH!

GYAAGH!

"SHE LICKED THAT KNIFE LIKE A KID LICKING THE FROSTING OFF A *BIRTHDAY CANDLE,* AND SUDDENLY I *KNEW...*

"...THEY WANTED MY *BLOOD...* AND *LINDA* WAS JUST AS DEAD AS *SCOTTY.*"

HEE HEE HEEEE...

"BASTARDS HAD *TAKEN* HER, JUST LIKE CHERYL AND SHELLY.

"AND I COULDN'T *CARE* ANYMORE.

"WHATEVER THE *HELL* HAD CRAWLED *INSIDE* THEM...

"...*KANDARIAN DEMON-SCUM* OR JUST A BAD CASE OF *CAT SCRATCH FEVER...*"

AHHHHHH!!!

"...I WAS GONNA HAVE TO *PLAY DIRTY* OR DIE."

TIK

"I NEEDED TO STAY *FOCUSED*, BUT IT WAS *DIFFICULT.*

"EVERY MOVE I MADE WAS PULLING UP *MEMORIES*, AND SUDDENLY I WAS BACK AT HER *DORM*..."

LINDA, I HAD A WONDERFUL TIME...

I DID, TOO!

IT'S *REFRESHING* TO GO OUT WITH A REAL SOUTHERN *GENTLEMAN.*

KTCHINK

TINK

"YEAH, THAT WAS ME.

"MISTER 'GONE WITH THE FRIGGIN' *WIND*'...

"...THE *PICTURE* OF ROMANTIC PROPRIETY..."

OH, MY GOD! YOU'RE... *INCREDIBLE.*

TOUCH ME, ASH...

...BUT...BE *GENTLE.*

"GENTLE. *RIGHT.*"

BABY, I'M GONNA HAVE YOU *PURRING LIKE A KITTEN.*

OH, *ASH...*

"HER SKIN WAS WARM. SOFT. *INVITING.*

"I PULLED HER CLOSE AND *KISSED HER* LIKE THERE WAS *NO TOMORROW.*

"IN THAT MOMENT, YEAH, I GUESS I REALLY *LOVED* HER.

RRRRRRRRR

RRRRRRRRR

"SO TELL ME WHAT I WAS DOING OUT IN THAT *WOODSHED.*

"THEN TAKE A CRACK AT EXPLAINING IT ALL.

"I COULDN'T DO IT. NOT TO *HER.*

RRRRRRRRR

"MAYBE *SOMEDAY* I'D BE ABLE TO TAKE A CHAINSAW TO MY GIRLFRIEND."

OH, LINDA...

"BUT IT WASN'T GONNA BE *TODAY.*

"SHE'D BE PUT TO *REST*, BUT IT WASN'T GONNA BE IN *PIECES*.

"THESE DEMONS WERE PRETTY TOUGH, BUT THE GROUND SEEMED TO HOLD WHAT WAS LEFT OF SHELLY.

"SHE DESERVED A REAL FUNERAL...FLOWERS AND PRETTY WORDS...BUT ALL I COULD GIVE HER WAS A HOLE IN THE *DIRT*.

"AT LEAST HER TORMENT WOULD BE *OVER*.

"RIGHT...?

"I SHOULD HAVE SAID *GOODBYE* THEN AND THERE. HIGH-TAILED IT TO THE NEAREST *MENTAL INSTITUTION*.

"BUT THEN I SAW THE *NECKLACE*--THE ONE I'D *GIVEN* HER EARLIER THAT NIGHT."

AHH! AHH! *AUGHHH!!*

HEE HEE HEE HEEEE...

"THAT SETTLED IT. NEXT TIME I REALLY *WOULD* USE THE SAW.

"BUT RIGHT NOW, I HAD TO SETTLE FOR AN OLD *RAILROAD TIE*."

KRAKK

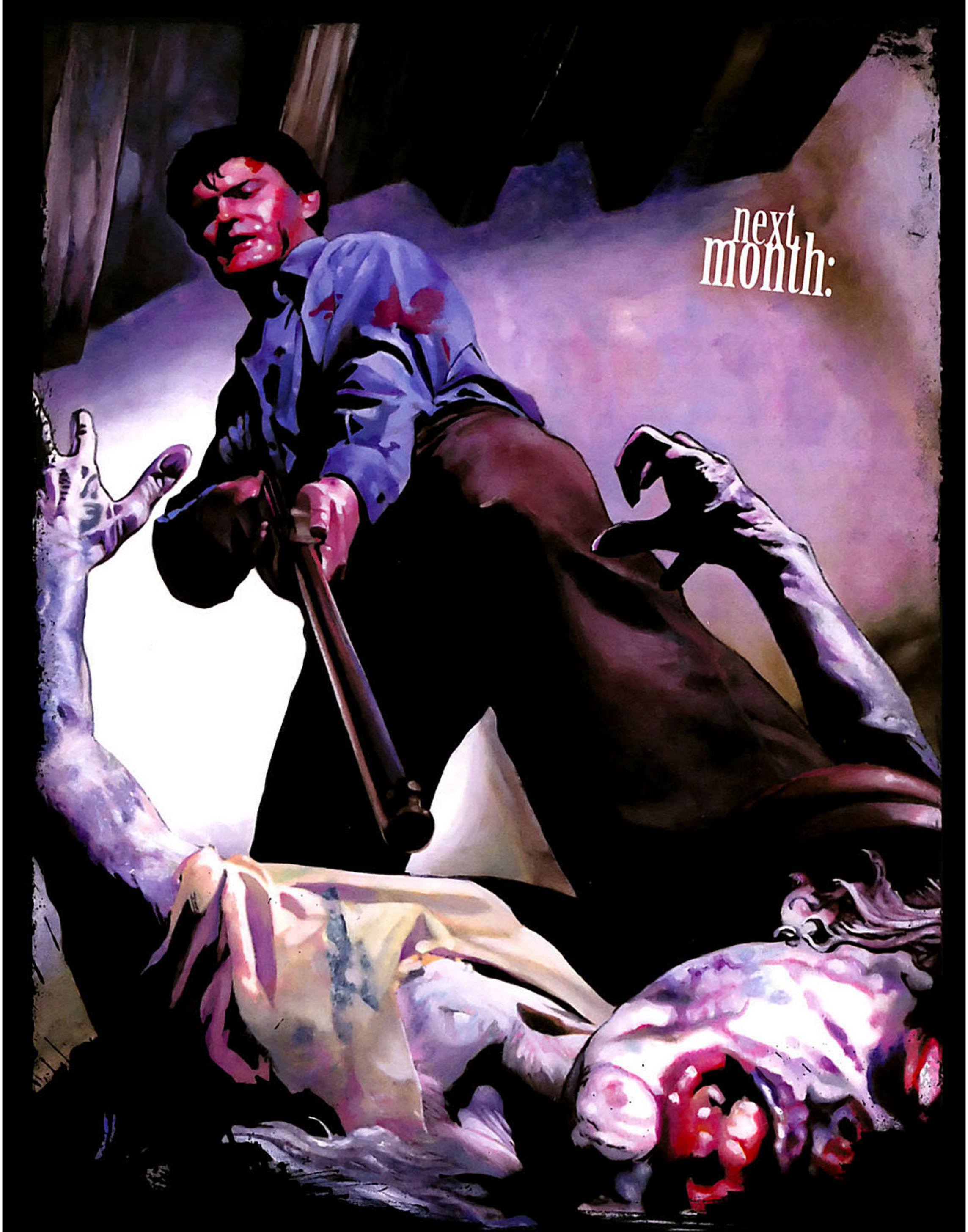
"BUT IT WASN'T *ENOUGH.*

"WHATEVER WAS COMING AT ME, I HAD TO REMEMBER...

"...IT WASN'T LINDA!!"

SHHH

HRRRAAAHHH!



"I didn't know it then, but there had been a change in strategy. Phase one had been a frontal assault. Phase two was simpler . . . scare the livin' bejesus out of me."

Ash is on his last nerve—and that very last nerve has to hold or he'll be boarding a train straight to Crazy Town. As Ash strives to stay sane and fight his way through deadite versions of his friends, will the terrifying power of the Necronomicon hold the key to his survival? With a possessed cabin also pummeling him with horror and hard knocks, will Ash still be standing when the final page of this unique adaptation is turned?? What twisted words and paintings will come out of our Verheiden/Bolton Dream Team??? The final chapter of *The Evil Dead* is upon us!!!

DEADITE LETTER OFFICE

Write to us at:
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philips@darkhorse.com

Dear deadites far below and elsewhere! We've been getting such a great flurry of letters for our first issue alone, I'm going to shut my piehole and just let your letters run wild. Before I do that, though, I'd like to direct your attention to Mr. John Bolton's website. It's pretty simple: johnbolton.com. John wanted me to tell you wonderful, giggling freaks that he has original art to sell!! Jared and Drew took the time to send us handwritten, old-fashioned-style letters, so I'll let them go first . . .

Regarding the new Dark Horse *Evil Dead* comic, I just read the first issue, and I can't wait to read the next! The added dialogue and Ash's new narration make the story very enjoyable. I also love what has been shown of professor Knowby in the cabin before Ash and the gang arrive. I think the new comic is giving *Evil Dead* fans exactly what they want—more of a good thing! Mark Verheiden has done an amazing job at keeping things the same, while adding exactly what we want to see. I can hear Scottie's voice in my head when I hear him shout, "Your damn steering wheel jerked right out of my hands!" and original dialogue like that keeps all the characters' voices fresh in my head. On a final note, John Bolton's art in this issue was amazing! I'm glad to see the painted look, instead of cartoonish-looking illustrations, which can be great, however I think the painted style works much better for horror comics. Every page was a real treat to look at and went with Mark Verheiden's new take on the story perfectly! Like I said, I can't wait until the next issue! Thanks for the chance to write in!

Jared Smith, Billerica, Massachusetts

I loved the first issue of *The Evil Dead*! The artwork was just as good and genius as the story. I love how it is told in the past tense by Ash. I remember the first time I saw *The Evil Dead*, and it scared the hell out of me. It still scares me to this day when I watch it. Every time I get done and am about to go to bed my imagination runs wild, and I always imagine Cheryl stabbing my ankle with a pencil from under my bed. So I always jump into my bed after watching it. Not a lot of films scare me but *The Evil Dead* does, and the funny thing is, I love it! It's a scary movie that I want to watch again and again. So I thank you from the fruit cellar of my heart for not only doing this comics books series, but for doing it right.

Drew Van Ess, New Castle, Delaware

You have no idea how long I've been waiting for this! I've been a huge fan since the age of around eight. I remember being so scared when I first saw it that I wouldn't sit in the living room. I would take my woobie (my childhood blanket) and would peek around the corner watching it from the well-lit hallway. After seeing that movie, I turned into a horror movie junkie. I was nine years old when I started my Freddy Kruger Fan Club in a little child-sized shed in my backyard. Kids joined my club (kinda like the one in *Monster Squad*), but few had actually seen any of the movies due to parental guidance. Anyway, *Evil Dead* started my love for horror . . . and as for your book, I think it's fantastic! The art fits like a glove! John's art is great, and I can't wait to see more! The writing is great as well. I really enjoy the subtle things that weren't in the movie, and I hope there's plenty more of that kind of stuff in future issues. So keep it up and thank you so much for this!

Gentry Edwards, via email

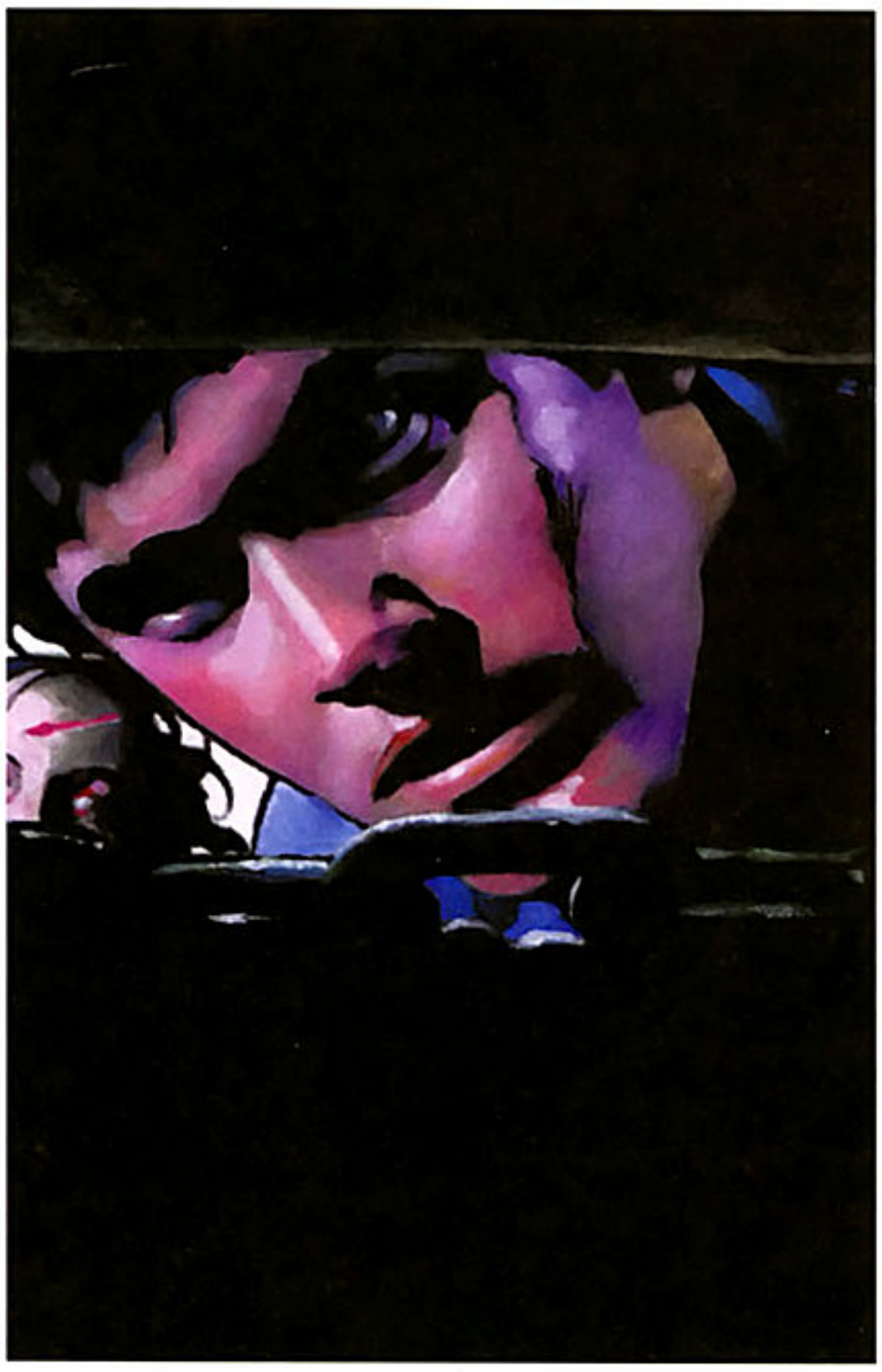
Jesus Fucking Christ!!! Thanks to the Devil for this one! Across the years, one of my dreams was to see something on paper of *The Evil Dead*. Thanks Mr. Verheiden, thanks Dark Horse Comics, and specially thanks Mr. John Bolton for this work. That *Army of Darkness* adaptation that Mr. Bolton made showed me that he was the man for the job, and fifteen years later we can see that with Mr. Bolton we just want to see more! You know, here in Mexico the movie was called *El Despertar del Diablo* (which translates to *The Devil's Awakening*), so I simply didn't know what to expect from it. And when I saw it on a beta cassette in 1986 it almost made me cry with its power and intensity. Some years later, I saw

it on 35 mm and it was like see something new, with the really enjoyable experience of hearing the shouts of other people and seeing some of them even leave the theater after some of the heavy scenes. To this day, curiously, *The Evil Dead* has not been available on DVD in Mexico, so we get import editions. I have watched mine like thirty times. Well, guys, please just keep up the great work!

Mauricio Matamoros, via email

Wow! You guys outdid yourselves on this one. I didn't know what to expect, as I am a huge fan of the movie series and have been waiting on a serious comic adaptation. Not only did you not disappoint, you took it a step further! I have never written a comment on a comic before, but I had to say kudos on the great story expansion by Mark Verheiden, and *good God* John Bolton had better pace himself—the art knocked me on the floor! Keep up the great work, and I am looking forward to the next issue.

Michael P. Stevens,
Battle Creek, Michigan



I just finished reading *The Evil Dead* #1. Excellent. Feels right to me. Feels like the original movie. I was worried that the phenomenon would overtake this comic and cheese it up, but it's an authentic adaptation. The art is great, and I love the dead things! Can't wait to see all of the sick and disgusting things to come. As for my first experience with this movie, I was under the influence when I saw *The Evil Dead* and *Evil Dead II* back-to-back one night. As strange as things got that night, I found the movies even stranger, and better, the next time I watched them . . . sober. I wish more classics were adapted for comics. Thanks for taking on *The Evil Dead* and for doing it justice.

Matt Strackbein, Longmont, Colorado

Hey, gang! Loved the first issue! I've always tried to get ahold of Bolton's work in the past, and I was psyched to see that he was on this. As an *Evil Dead* completist and true Ash fan, this book was hard to resist. I can honestly say from the atmosphere of John's paintings I felt like I was drawn into the movie. The colors and shadows were on point, holding still the high dramatic light sources and movement. At the end of it all, it's all about the monsters! The deadite characters are amazing! The color of the gore and the disturbing quality still hold very true to Mr. [Tom] Sullivan's FX works and designs from the original. I can't wait to read the new dialogue and see where this goes. There's nothing better than new material for you from your favorite horror characters. Comic looks awesome!

Buz Hasson, via email

Being a fairly young horror fan I didn't get to see *The Evil Dead* in its notorious "Video Nasty" heyday, but I was well aware of the controversy surrounding it, even when it was finally put out to buy on VHS in the shops. After viewing a few other titles on the same list and being quite disappointed with some of them, it was with mixed feelings I sat down to watch *The Evil Dead* for the first time. The next ninety-odd minutes were fantastic, *Evil Dead* finally presented me with something that I thought was worthy of the "Video Nasty" title. What's more, by the time I had seen it, the two sequels were readily available, too. I devoured these very soon afterwards, but the original, in my eyes, will always remain my favourite. I saw your *Evil Dead* comic sitting on the shelf in a local comic shop and instantly picked it up. I'm glad I did, and the first issue had me hooked from the start. The artwork is superb and the back story to the characters gives us further insight into the film itself. Even though I knew what was coming up, it still had me turning the page far faster than other comics I regularly buy. I just want to congratulate everyone involved in making this, and I'm looking forward to the next three issues. I must admit that a completely new and original *Evil Dead* storyline would be a great addition to any fan's collection. I'll be watching and waiting . . . and buying!

Simon Taylor, via email

Thanks, everyone! Visit again next month, when Ash says, "Two plus two suddenly equaled four." We'll be waiting here in the cabin with our final (?) issue of The Evil Dead*!!*

—Philip Simon
(fellow giggling freak)

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